

■ Virtual Cinema App – Step-by-Step Roadmap

This roadmap guides you from your initial idea to a fully working virtual cinema app — a platform where users can watch movies together, chat, and see each other's reactions in real time.

■ Phase 1: Foundation (Week 1–2)

- Learn HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React.js, Node.js, and Express.
- Install VS Code, Node.js, and set up Git + GitHub.
- Build a simple welcome page with 'Create Room' and 'Join Room' buttons.

■ Phase 2: Watch Together System (Week 3–4)

- Use Socket.io for real-time communication between users.
- Sync play/pause and video time across all viewers.
- Start with YouTube videos for easier setup.

■ Phase 3: Add Video Chat & Reactions (Week 5–6)

- Use WebRTC for webcam and microphone features.
- Show participants' video boxes.
- Add emoji reactions like ♥■ ■ ■ ■.

■ Phase 4: Interface Upgrade (Week 7–8)

- Add a main video window, chat panel, and participants toggle icon.
- Include buttons for mute, video off, and reactions.
- Use Tailwind CSS for design and Framer Motion for animations.

■ Phase 5: Authentication & Rooms (Week 9–10)

- Integrate Firebase Authentication for user login/signup.
- Let users create private watch rooms.
- Generate shareable room links.

■ Phase 6: Testing & Launch (Week 11–12)

- Fix bugs (sync lag, camera issues).
- Host on Vercel (frontend) and Render/Firebase (backend).
- Invite friends to test your platform and collect feedback.

■ Optional Future Add-ons

- Add screen sharing.
- Create a subscription system.
- Integrate a movie library or Netflix APIs.
- Develop a VR/AR cinema experience.